The Six Skills Behavioral Scale

Capability is behavior under conditions. Every anchor below is observable.

From ***AI Will Scale Good Leadership and Bad Leadership:*** *The CHRO's Method for Redesigning Work Before AI Scales What's Broken* by Liz Corey · Toolbox No. 8 · Companion to the Capability Gap Assessment

HOW TO USE THIS SCALE

1. Run the three scenarios from the Capability Gap Assessment with real artifacts from your own company.
2. While you watch, tick one level per skill for each person. Behavior, not vocabulary. A brief is either complete or it is not. A citation was either checked or it was not.
3. Carry the six ratings to the Team Map. Rehearse the lowest skill next. Reassess after rehearsal cycles, not calendar quarters.

SKILL	1 BEGINNER	2 DEVELOPING	3 OPERATOR
Delegation Writing the complete assignment (goal, context, constraints, output) and recognizing when a weak result traces to a weak brief.	☐ **1** Types a one-line request and takes what comes back. Fixes weak output by hand.	☐ **2** Writes goal and output. Context and constraints are thin. Sometimes traces a weak result to the brief.	☐ **3** Writes all four parts without prompting. When output is weak, rewrites the assignment, not the output.
Inquiry Knowing how to ask the next question. Not accepting the first answer, even when it sounds good.	☐ **1** Accepts the first answer. Asks nothing further.	☐ **2** Asks one follow-up when something looks off.	☐ **3** Stays in the question: what is missing, what changed, what assumption is hiding, what have I not thought to ask.
Output interrogation Treating fluency as a claim, not a credential. Asking what in this document must be true for it to be safe, and checking exactly those things.	☐ **1** Proofreads for tone and typos. Forwards the fabricated citation.	☐ **2** Spot-checks a fact or two. Catches an error when it looks wrong.	☐ **3** Names what must be true for the output to be safe, checks exactly those things, and catches the fabrication.
Verification judgment Knowing how much scrutiny this output deserves: wrongness cost and verification cost applied at the desk level.	☐ **1** Scrutinizes everything or nothing. Drowns or detonates.	☐ **2** Adjusts scrutiny when reminded of the stakes.	☐ **3** Scrutiny matches the cost of being wrong. The recap gets a skim. The compliance answer gets the full treatment.
Coaching Naming good output so it repeats. Tracing poor output to its cause (the brief, the context, the standard) and correcting there. Still coaching the person, not handing them an AI answer.	☐ **1** Patches poor output by hand. Hands people AI answers and calls it development.	☐ **2** Names good output. Traces some poor output to the brief.	☐ **3** Corrects at the cause every time, for the agent and the person. Examines thinking, tests assumptions, improves the next attempt.
Reinvestment discipline The personal habit of deciding what freed capacity should become, before volume fills it.	☐ **1** Freed hours fill with more of the same.	☐ **2** Can name where some freed time went.	☐ **3** Decides in advance what the capacity becomes, and can show it.

Notice what the list is. Delegate, inquire, interrogate, verify, coach, reinvest. These are management skills in the order of a manager's day. There is no separate discipline called working with AI. The only thing new is the worker.

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SCORING SHEET

One person, three scenarios

Person: _____ **Role:** _____ **Date:** _____ **Quiz score (of 10):** _____

1 The fabricated citation

Setup: An AI-drafted policy answer (or termination letter) that cites a policy section that does not exist, handed over under deadline pressure. Say nothing about the fabrication in advance.

Watch for: Did they verify the citation, or admire the prose? How quickly? Did they name what had to be true for the document to be safe?

Skills it reveals: Output interrogation, Verification judgment, Inquiry

What they did: _____

2 The ambiguous escalation

Setup: A flagged agent escalation that arrives ambiguous: a benefits question routed to a person with a low-confidence note and no clear reason.

Watch for: Did they escalate, investigate, or shrug? Did they ask what the agent was missing? Did they treat the pattern as a knowledge problem before an agent problem?

Skills it reveals: Inquiry, Coaching, Verification judgment

What they did: _____

3 The weak first draft

Setup: A real delegation: they brief AI on a task, and the first output is mediocre on purpose.

Watch for: Did they fix the output or fix the assignment? Was the rewritten brief complete (goal, context, constraints, output)? Did they say what the freed time becomes?

Skills it reveals: Delegation, Coaching, Reinvestment discipline

What they did: _____

4 Ratings and the plan

SKILL	RATING (1 TO 3)	SKILL	RATING (1 TO 3)
Delegation		**Verification judgment**	
Inquiry		**Coaching**	
Output interrogation		**Reinvestment discipline**	

Quadrant: ☐ Operator ☐ Natural ☐ Honest beginner ☐ Confident beginner **Autonomy:** ☐ Grant on evidence ☐ Supervised ☐ Hold

Rehearse next: _____

Want this run for you? The Six Skills Interview Agent interviews candidates and employees against this scale. Available now. Call for pricing. Book a conversation at onthegrow.ai

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